AN OPEN STANDARD + A MARK WORTH EARNING

Built for *any body.*

MIDI let any keyboard play any synth. This lets any musician play any instrument: an open manufacturing standard for disability-accessible instruments and music gear, and the Heartmark that proves a product meets it.

From an idea by Sam, for Bennet

Limitless Sound × Panda Studios

OPEN SPEC · FREE TO BUILD · 10% TO MUSICIANS

01 THE IDEA

Accessibility as a *feature people want*, not a box someone ticks.

Sam's idea: Limitless Sound writes the standard that instrument and gear makers build to, the way the whole industry builds to MIDI. Products that meet it earn a mark. And the mark is designed from day one to be **something musicians look for and companies are proud to wear**, the way people seek out THX, B Corp or Fair Trade.

The spec

Open and free, forever

What a product has to do so any body can play it: how it is reached, connected, sensed, adapted, endured and explained. Anyone can read it, build to it and test against it at no cost.

GROWS FROM ACCESS STANDARD 0.1

The mark

Earned, public, revocable

Four levels, from Connected to Co-designed. Passing is proven with a public test report, and musicians can flag a product that stops living up to it. That is what makes it mean something.

THE STATUS SYMBOL

The fund

The mark pays musicians

Only the mark is licensed. 10% of every license goes straight to disabled musicians: gear grants, paid studio time, paid testing seats, and the Builders fellowship in section 09.

MISSION FUNDED BY ADOPTION

Why a standard, and not just more apps

Six free apps can help thousands of musicians. A standard changes what every company ships. Around **1.3 billion people, about 1 in 6**, live with a significant disability (World Health Organization). Today almost no instrument, amp or plug-in tells them, on the box, whether it will work for their body. The Heartmark does: *set up your access once, and everything you pick up already fits you.*

WE ARE NOT STARTING FROM ZERO

Draft 0.1 of the Limitless Access Standard already exists in the repository, with four levels and a working test kit (`las_check.py`) built on the Limitless Link protocol all six apps speak. It covers software. This concept adds what Sam is asking for: **physical manufacturing requirements for hardware, a name, a mark people want, a licensing model, and a way for disabled musicians to build their own tools with Claude.**

02 WHAT TO CALL IT

Three layers, *three names*.

A standard needs a precise technical name engineers can cite. A mark needs a name people say out loud. The box needs a phrase a shopper gets in half a second. Five options, with a recommended set.

Limitless Access Standard (LAS)

THE SPEC ENGINEERS CITE

RECOMMENDED

Already the working name, and the heart logo already spells L·A·S. The brand and the standard become one thing without a redesign. “LAS Level 3” reads like “USB 3”.

Watch out: it carries the Limitless name, so a rival maker may hesitate. A neutral council (section 07) answers that.

The Heartmark

THE MARK PEOPLE SAY OUT LOUD

RECOMMENDED

The heart logo, earned. “Does it have the Heartmark?” is something a guitar-shop employee can ask. It says compassion, not compliance, which is exactly the line we want to hold: an ethical mark, not a legal certificate.

Watch out: “heart mark” is used in health and charity settings, so it needs a trademark search in music and electronics classes.

Made for Any Body

THE LINE PRINTED ON THE BOX

RECOMMENDED

Plain, warm, and impossible to misread. It turns the 38x plan’s line, “any musician, any body, any input, any tool”, into a promise on a shelf tag.

AMI: Accessible Music Interface

ALTERNATIVE SPEC NAME

A deliberate echo of MIDI (Musical Instrument Digital Interface), and “ami” means friend in French. The most neutral option for big manufacturers to adopt.

Watch out: AMI is a crowded acronym, and it loses the Limitless brand.

Limitless Ready

ALTERNATIVE MARK NAME

Works like “Made for iPhone” or “Works with Alexa”: instantly understood as compatibility.

Watch out: sounds like a plug-in check, not something to be proud of. Less of a status symbol.

Every name here needs a trademark search before it is announced. That is a cheap first step and the first item in section 10.

Six pillars, for *hardware and software*.

Draft 0.1 asks how a product connects. A manufacturing standard also has to ask how it is **touched, heard, seen, carried and opened**. These are draft requirements to refine with the musicians' council; each gets a check id like the 0.1 ones.

Reach CAN MY BODY OPERATE IT?

R1	Every core control works with one hand or one foot, with no tight grasping, pinching or wrist twisting.
R2	Operating force of 22 N (5 lbf) or less, matching the ADA rule for operable parts; lighter is better and is published.
R3	No core function needs two controls pressed at once without a single-press alternative.
R4	Standard mount threads (1/4"-20 and 3/8"-16) so it fixes to a wheelchair, desk arm or mic stand.
R5	Any hold-to-operate control can be set to latch instead.

Connect CAN ANY INPUT DRIVE IT?

C1	Every function reachable remotely over USB-MIDI or MIDI 2.0, and over Limitless Link natively or through a bridge.
C2	Hardware with a footswitch jack or a 3.5 mm assistive switch jack (the same jacks as the Xbox Adaptive Controller).
C3	Actions announced with plain labels a screen reader can speak (60 characters or less). From 0.1
C4	Answers every action within 3 seconds; a refusal says why, out loud. From 0.1

Sense CAN I TELL WHAT IT'S DOING?

S1	Nothing is shown by color alone: lights also differ by shape, position, blink or label. Checked with Limitless Color's simulator.
S2	Every state change can be confirmed through at least two senses: sight, sound or touch.
S3	Screen text meets 4.5:1 contrast (WCAG AA) and can be enlarged.
S4	Tactile landmarks: center detents, raised home markers, distinct knob shapes.
S5	Visual or haptic metronome, tuner and meters, so Deaf and hard-of-hearing players get the same information.

Adapt DOES IT FIT ME, ONCE?

A1	Honors the musician's shared Access Profile (text size, contrast, reduced motion, dwell and scan timing) within 3 seconds. 0.1 Level 2
A2	Every control can be remapped.
A3	Settings export and import as a file, so a musician's setup travels from studio to stage.

Endure DOES IT RESPECT FATIGUE, PAIN, TREMOR?

E1	Adjustable sensitivity and debounce, so a tremor isn't read as a press.
E2	No timed response that can't be lengthened or turned off.
E3	Weight published; work is auto-saved, so stopping mid-session loses nothing.

Explain CAN I SET IT UP MYSELF?

X1	Manual in a screen-reader-friendly digital form, in plain language, with captioned setup videos.
X2	Packaging opens with one hand and no tools.
X3	An accessibility support contact that a person answers.
X4	A public access statement that also says what is *not* accessible yet.

Four levels. *Two tracks.*

The four levels from draft 0.1 stay, so the test kit and the apps that already speak the protocol keep working. Each level now has a **software track** (apps, plug-ins, DAWs) and a **hardware track** (instruments, amps, pedals, controllers). Each level includes the ones before it.

LEVEL	SOFTWARE TRACK	HARDWARE TRACK
Connected TESTED BY THE KIT	Joins the hub, announces its actions with plain labels, answers in 3 seconds, works the same with no hub (C3, C4).	Every function reachable over MIDI and Limitless Link, natively or through a certified bridge (C1); mount threads (R4); public access statement (X4).
Adaptive KIT + CHECKLIST	Honors the Access Profile (A1), remappable (A2), nothing by color alone (S1), readable text (S3).	Reach rules R1 to R3 and R5, switch or footswitch jack (C2), two-sense feedback (S2), tremor settings (E1).
Hands-free ATTESTED WITH VIDEO	The core job, start to finish, by eyes, by voice or by one switch. For a DAW, recording a take; for an amp modeler, picking and shaping a tone.	The instrument can be played, not just configured, with no hands: by foot, breath, switch, eyes or voice, through its own jacks or a bridge.
Co-designed MUSICIAN PANEL	Tested with at least three disabled musicians with different access needs, **paid for their time and credited by name** if they choose. Their feedback is answered in a public changelog. Docs and packaging meet X1 to X3. This is the level that becomes the status symbol.	

EXISTING GEAR JOINS THROUGH A BRIDGE

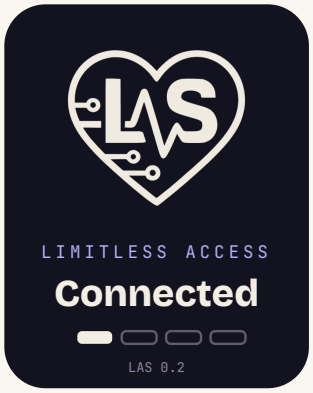
A 1998 synth or a guitar with no electronics can't be redesigned. A small bridge app that speaks Limitless Link on one side and MIDI, USB or Bluetooth on the other can carry the mark for that device. Limitless Control already does this for the Xbox Adaptive Controller, and GazeStage's XY pad already drives a Line 6 Helix over MIDI. Bridges are where musicians and Claude come in (section 09).

RIDING ON MIDI ITSELF

MIDI 2.0 has "profiles" that let devices agree on a shared behavior. Once the spec settles, the Access Profile could be proposed to the MIDI Association as one, so any MIDI 2.0 device can pick up a musician's settings over the cable they already use. That is the literal version of "MIDI for accessibility", and a long-term goal, not a launch dependency.

Make it a *status symbol*.

The mark tells its level by **word and by filled bars, never by color alone**, so it passes its own standard. A first sketch for Sam to take further:



Any input can drive it



Fits your settings and your reach



Playable with no hands



Built with disabled musicians

What turns a badge into a status symbol

It is hard to get and easy to lose

Public test reports, a yearly re-check, and any musician can flag a product. A mark that can be revoked is a mark people trust.

It is seen on stage first

Certified gear is what artists play in the Panda Studios guest-feature series. The audience meets the mark in a performance, not a press release.

A public registry

One page per product: level, report, video walkthrough, and what musicians say about it. Searchable by access need, not just by brand.

It carries artists' names

Co-designed products credit the musicians who shaped them, like a signature model. "Co-designed with" becomes a line companies compete for.

Founding Partners

The first ten companies to certify a product get a permanent Founding Partner mark. Scarcity at launch pulls the industry in.

A yearly Heartmark night

Awards voted by disabled musicians, with performances on certified gear. Winning one is good press; being nominated is too.

06 HOW CERTIFICATION WORKS

From spec to shelf in *six steps*.

Software levels 1 and 2 are already checkable by machine today. Hardware adds a checklist and, from Level 3 up, people. The process is designed so a solo developer and a global brand go through the same door.

1. **Read the spec, free**
   Published openly with plain-language explanations and examples for every check.
2. **Self-test**
   Software runs `las_check.py` in its own CI and gets pass or fail per level. Hardware fills in the measured checklist (forces, jacks, contrast, packaging) with photos.
3. **Submit the report and evidence**
   The report JSON, plus an unedited video for Level 3 and the musicians' panel notes for Level 4.
4. **Review**
   Automatic checks are re-run. Level 3 and 4 evidence is reviewed by paid disabled musicians from the council's panel, not only by staff.
5. **License the mark**
   Sign the mark license; 10% of the fee goes straight into the Limitless Fund.
6. **Listed and kept honest**
   The product appears in the public registry. Re-checked every year and on every major version; a musician's flag triggers a re-test.

THE LINE WE NEVER CROSS

The Heartmark is a voluntary, compassionate mark written with disabled musicians. It is not a legal accessibility certification and does not claim compliance with the ADA, Section 508, the European Accessibility Act or any other law. Saying so plainly is part of why people will trust it.

07 LICENSING AND GOVERNANCE

Free to build. *Licensed to wear.*

The spec costs nothing, so nobody is priced out of accessibility. The mark is what companies pay for, and that money pays disabled musicians.

THE SPEC	Free and open to implement, forever. No fee to read, build to or self-test against it. Only the mark is licensed.
MARK LICENSE	A yearly fee scaled to company size. **Free for independent developers, nonprofits and musician-built tools.** Exact bands set with the first partners.
GIVING BACK	10% of every license goes straight to disabled musicians: gear grants, paid studio time, paid testing seats, and the Builders fellowship. Reported publicly every year.
WHO DECIDES	A council with a majority of disabled musicians, across different disabilities, decides changes to the spec and these terms. Manufacturers get a seat, not a veto. This is also what lets competitors adopt a standard with “Limitless” in its name.
PROOF STAYS PUBLIC	Every certified product’s report and evidence is published. No secret passes.

The apps are the *proof it works*.

Every pillar already has a working Limitless Sound app behind it. That is the difference between a nice idea and a standard: **the reference implementations exist, are free, and install on any Mac or Windows computer.**

Hub — **Limitless Hub + Link protocol**
THE CABLE · CONNECT
The open action bus every app speaks. It is to the standard what the 5-pin cable was to MIDI.

Kit — **las_check.py test kit**
THE JUDGE · ALL LEVELS
Already passes or fails software for Levels 1 and 2, and records evidence for 3 and 4. Grows a hardware checklist in 0.2.

Vo — **Limitless Voice**
HANDS-FREE · LEVEL 3
Records a take in Logic or Pro Tools by voice alone: the reference for "core job with no hands".

Gz — **GazeStage**
HANDS-FREE · FIRST HARDWARE DEMO
Eyes-only playing with an ordinary webcam. Its XY tone pad already shapes a Line 6 Helix over MIDI.

Ct — **Limitless Control**
BRIDGE · HARDWARE TRACK
The Xbox Adaptive Controller bridge: the pattern any existing device uses to join and carry the mark.

1H — **One-Hand Keys**
REACH
Every DAW shortcut from one hand, left or right. The reference for R1 and R3.

Zm — **Limitless Zoom**
ADAPT · SENSE
Low-vision zoom that follows the shared text-size setting: the reference for the Access Profile (A1).

Co — **Limitless Color**
SENSE · TEST TOOL
Colorblind tuner and filters. Its simulator becomes the tool that checks S1: nothing by color alone.

Connected to the 38x plan

The 38x plan calls this the third pillar: software, then the artist program, then *the standard*. The flywheel is the same: artists prove certified gear on camera, the videos bring sponsors, sponsors certify their products, and 10% of every license flows back to the artists who bring in the next musician. The Line 6 Helix XY episode and a Kiesel signature conversation are natural first candidates.

Claude for disabled musicians: *build your own*.

No standard can predict every body. So the last piece hands the tools over. **Limitless Builders** helps disabled musicians describe what they need, in their own words, and work with Claude to build it, for music and for the rest of life. This whole suite was built that way, by a small team working with Claude; the Builders program makes that possible for the musicians themselves.

> *"When I puff the straw twice, punch in recording."*

A tiny bridge from a sip-and-puff switch to the hub's `daw.record`.

> *"Read me my levels out loud after every take."*

A helper that listens for "take ended" and speaks the meters.

> *"Let my left foot step through my Helix presets."*

A footswitch mapping through Limitless Control, saved to their profile.

How it works

1 · SAY IT

Talk, don't type

Describe the need by voice, eye typing in GazeStage, or one switch. Building shouldn't need hands either.

2 · BUILD IT

The Builder Kit

An open starter project with a CLAUDE.md that already knows the protocol and the standard, so Claude writes a tool that speaks Limitless Link from the first try.

3 · TEST IT

The kit checks it

las_check runs on every change. The musician tries it and keeps it only when it works for their body.

4 · SHARE IT

Builders' Library

Tools that pass can be shared, free, with a Community-built Heartmark, so the next musician starts further ahead.

Builders fellowship

Paid from the Limitless Fund: a stipend, access to Claude, and a mentor for musicians who want to build. Fellows' tools become bridges other musicians use.

Beyond the studio

The same skills apply to life: reading paperwork aloud, writing emails by voice, organizing gigs and bookings. Music is the door, not the limit.

Honest by design

Tools run on the musician's own computer and they stay in control. Claude can make mistakes, which is why every tool is tested by the kit and by the person who uses it.

10 NEXT 90 DAYS

From concept to the *first mark on a box*.

WEEKS 1–2

Name it

- Bennet and Sam pick the names.
- Trademark search in music and electronics classes.
- Sam takes the mark sketch further.

WEEKS 3–6

Draft 0.2

- Add the hardware track and six pillars to the spec.
- Add a hardware checklist to the test kit.
- Recruit the first five council members, paid.
- Open for public comment.

WEEKS 7–10

First partner

- Helix via GazeStage XY as the first hardware demo, filmed at Panda Studios.
- Founding Partner talks with Line 6 and Kiesel.
- Set the license bands with them.

WEEKS 11–13

Builders v1

- Publish the Builder Kit.
- First two musician-built tools in the Library.
- Announce the Heartmark with the first video.

Four calls for Bennet and Sam

The names

Limitless Access Standard, the Heartmark, and “Made for Any Body”, or one of the alternatives in section 02.

SUGGESTED: THE RECOMMENDED SET

How much goes back

10% of every mark license to disabled musicians is in draft 0.1. It could be higher once the program pays for itself.

SUGGESTED: START AT 10%, REVIEW YEARLY

Who holds the mark

Limitless Sound, or a separate nonprofit that a council runs. A nonprofit is easier for competitors to trust.

SUGGESTED: PLAN FOR A NONPROFIT BY V1.0

The first partner

Line 6 (Helix already takes MIDI, so the XY pad works today) or Kiesel (a co-designed signature conversation).

SUGGESTED: LINE 6 FIRST, KIESEL FOR LEVEL 4



No one *left behind*.

Any musician. Any body. Any input. Any tool. Help write the standard: musicians and makers are both invited.

Concept 0.2, October 2026, building on the Limitless Access Standard draft 0.1 and its test kit in the Limitless Sound repository. Requirements are drafts for the musicians' council to refine. The Heartmark is a voluntary, ethical mark and not a legal accessibility certification; it makes no claim of compliance with the ADA, Section 508, the European Accessibility Act or any other law. Names are proposals pending trademark search. The figure of 1.3 billion people with significant disability is from the World Health Organization.